curfews, security checks, arbitrary arrests, torture, rape and extra-judicial killings.'[51] Protests remained a regular occurrence in the Kashmir Valley, and major demonstrations had erupted every summer since 2008. This cycle continued in 2010 when, during clashes with protestors, police fired a teargas shell that struck and killed a seventeen-year old boy on his way home from school. Separatists immediately called for a strike to protest his death, and more clashes soon erupted between demonstrators and the security forces.[52] Additional strikes and protests ensued, but in addition to these there was also a grassroots uprising by Kashmiri youth. Their weapon of choice was not the gun or the bomb, but rather the rock. Stone-throwing throngs of young people confronted the security forces on an almost daily basis throughout the summer. Local police, who were not equipped to control large crowds, repeatedly fired into them, killing unarmed protesters and fueling additional unrest.[53] Unlike the 1990s when unarmed civilians demonstrated against Indian rule *and* militants fought the security forces, there was virtually no militant activity this time. By summer's end some Indian analysts had begun referring to the street violence as the 'Kashmir Intifada,' highlighting the degree to which the unrest was led by rock-throwing youth as opposed to militant outfits or separatist leaders.[54] These boys had not trained in Pakistan, were not tainted by association with the ISI and many disliked the militants. But they viewed the Indian security forces as a brutal occupying force.[55] In short, the political grievances that sparked the insurgency in 1989 were still present, even while the Kashmir jihad they sparked had waned.

Meanwhile the insurgency in Afghanistan remained robust and Lashkar's members were fighting there in greater numbers in Afghanistan by late 2009—early 2010. The flow of Lashkar fighters increased into Kunar and Nuristan provinces in eastern Afghanistan, which remained the primary focal point for the group's operations.[56] The integration of the group's members with the Taliban and Haqqani Network also accelerated, enabling Lashkar fighters to expand their presence.[57] For example, in summer 2010 a joint Afghan-international security force operation led to the capture of a Taliban commander who ISAF claims assisted with the 'recent influx' of Lashkar militants into Nangarhar province, which is located in eastern Afghanistan south of Kunar.[58] According to the top US military intelligence official in Afghanistan at the time, some Lashkar